

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-01

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 17:1-15

1 Now it came to pass, when David was dwelling in his house, that David said to Nathan the prophet, "See now, I dwell in a house of cedar, but the ark of the covenant of the Lord is under tent curtains."

2 Then Nathan said to David, "Do all that is in your heart, for God is with you."

3 But it happened that night that the word of God came to Nathan, saying,

4 "Go and tell My servant David, 'Thus says the Lord: "You shall not build Me a house to dwell in.

5 For I have not dwelt in a house since the time that I brought up Israel, even to this day, but have gone from tent to tent, and from one tabernacle to another.

6 Wherever I have moved about with all Israel, have I ever spoken a word to any of the judges of Israel, whom I commanded to shepherd My people, saying, 'Why have you not built Me a house of cedar?'"

7 Now therefore, thus shall you say to My servant David, 'Thus says the Lord of hosts: "I took you from the sheepfold, from following the sheep, to be ruler over My people Israel.

8 And I have been with you wherever you have gone, and have cut off all your enemies from before you, and have made you a name like the name of the great men who are on the earth.

9 Moreover I will appoint a place for My people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in a place of their own and move no more; nor shall the sons of wickedness oppress them anymore, as previously,

10 since the time that I commanded judges to be over My people Israel. Also I will subdue all your enemies. Furthermore I tell you that the Lord will build you a house.

11 And it shall be, when your days are fulfilled, when you must go to be with your fathers, that I will set up your seed after you, who will be of your sons; and I will establish his

kingdom.

12 He shall build Me a house, and I will establish his throne forever.

13 I will be his Father, and he shall be My son; and I will not take My mercy away from him, as I took it from him who was before you.

14 And I will establish him in My house and in My kingdom forever; and his throne shall be established forever.""

15 According to all these words and according to all this vision, so Nathan spoke to David.

II. Key Summary

- David, living in a house of cedar, thought about the ark of the covenant still being under tent curtains and told Nathan the prophet about it; Nathan answered, "Do all that is in your heart, for God is with you" (v1-2).
 - That night the word of God came to Nathan, telling him to say to David, "You shall not build Me a house to dwell in"; God said He had not dwelt in a house from the time He brought Israel up out of Egypt until that day, and had never asked any of the judges for a house of cedar (v3-6).
 - God reminded David that He took him from the sheepfold to be ruler over Israel, promised to be with him, cut off his enemies and appoint a place for Israel, and said, "The Lord will build you a house"; David's seed would build the house, and his throne would be established forever. Nathan told David all these words (v7-15).
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III. Passage Analysis

Even a reasonable plan has to be measured against God's will

"It is of the utmost importance that we should ever test our desires, even the highest and holiest of them, by His will. Work, excellent in itself, should never be undertaken, save at the express command of God." [1]

Nathan saw that God was with David, so he said straight away, "Do all that is in your heart" (v2); that night the word of God came to him, telling him to say to David, "You shall not build Me a house to dwell in" (v4). David's heart was not rebuked — what got corrected was who would do it and when.

You wanted to build God a house; God builds you one first

"David hoped to 'build' God a 'house' (v4), that is, to build the temple; God turned it around and promised that He would 'build' David a 'house' (v10), that is, establish a dynasty... For this is the order of God's work: God must first build a 'house' for a person before that person can build a 'house' for God." [2]

"House to dwell in" in verse 4 and "house" in verse 10 are the same word in the original. David spoke up about building God a temple, and God's answer was, "the Lord will build you a house" (v10), while the building of the temple was left to his seed (v11-12).

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you decided to do a good thing, who did you ask first?

Nathan answered right away, "Do all that is in your heart" (v2) — that was human judgment; then that night the word of God came to him, saying, "You shall not build Me a house to dwell in" (v4). The answer came from God speaking for Himself, and Nathan told David all these words (v15). [1]

References

[1] Enduring Word (David Guzik), Commentary on 1 Chronicles 17 (quoting G. Campbell Morgan), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-17/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site, "Comprehensive Interpretation of 1 Chronicles", <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT17.htm>